No wonder it is called the Wired Republic.'[8] All of this was indicative of how Modi viewed digital communication long before he became the BJP's prime ministerial candidate.

From pioneering the use of campaign audio and video cassettes in the 1980s during the Ram Janmabhoomi movement to adapting early to satellite television in the 1990s, and from Modi holograms in 2014 to dominating Facebook and WhatsApp in 2019, the BJP has always operated at the confluence of technology and politics.[9] In the late 1980s and up to 1992, the party powered its outreach on the Ram Temple movement with roadside ₹1 sales and mass distribution of audio cassettes containing fiery speeches on Ram by two women sanyasins—Uma Bharti (later member of Parliament and Madhya Pradesh chief minister) and Sadhvi Ritambhara from Ludhiana. The BJP's Ram Temple movement also rode the VCR boom, in the pre-internet and pre-satellite TV days, right into middle-class homes, through video cassettes containing religious songs like 'Pran Jaye Par Vachan Na Jaaye' (Let Go of Life but Not Your Word) and speeches. In many ways, these strategies reshaped direct political communications in India.[10]

By 1991, the party had begun hiring ad agencies like the Chennai-based RK Swamy BBDO Pvt Ltd, which created its 1991 election campaign using video cassettes produced at Delhi's Jain TV studios as well as devised the election taglines 'Enough is enough' and 'Let's Go With Ram Rajya, Let's Go With the BJP'.[11] In the 2000s, Modi took this party lineage of using technology for political packaging to another level—by using top Bollywood stars, first-mover advantage and deep usage of digital media, the use of top consultants—all of which ran parallel to the governance messaging campaign run by the party's foot soldiers.

In a country with more mobile phones than any other (except China), low data rates and a fast-urbanising population, the political use of digital technologies had changed the traditional modes of mobilisation. Where political messages were earlier mediated through gatekeepers like the media and opinion leaders who filtered them for the masses—in what was a two-step flow of information—the party now had the means to go directly to the people, and on a scale that was unimaginable earlier. The use of massive databases,